



## TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

### WEEK 27

Date:  Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

### TOPIC: Eye & Face Protection for Millwork & Carpentry

#### OVERVIEW:

Eye injuries in carpentry and millwork are extremely common and almost entirely preventable. Flying wood chips, sawdust, fastener ricochets, chemical splashes, and debris from grinding can cause corneal lacerations, chemical burns, and permanent vision loss. Unlike most injuries, eye damage is often

#### TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. Safety glasses must meet ANSI Z87.1, which is the standard for occupational eye protection. This standard defines impact resistance, optical clarity, and coverage. Regular prescription eyeglasses do not meet Z87.1 and do not provide adequate eye protection on a construction site — they can shatter on impact and send fragments into the eye. If you wear prescription lenses, use
2. Side shields are required whenever you are working in an area where projectile hazards come from the side — which on most carpentry jobs is essentially all the time. A standard pair of safety glasses without side shields leaves the eye exposed to ricochets and chips coming in from angles outside the forward-facing lens. For most millwork and finish carpentry work, safety glasses with
3. For overhead drilling, cutting, or grinding, safety glasses are not enough. Debris falls straight down into the gap between the glasses and your face. Use safety goggles or a face shield for overhead work. For chemical work — applying adhesives, stains, or solvents — chemical splash goggles provide protection against liquid that would bypass regular safety glasses. Know which
4. Know where the eye wash stations are before you need them. On a construction site, an emergency eye wash station may be a portable kit or a plumbed fixture. If a chemical splashes into your eye, you need to begin flushing immediately — every second of delay increases the severity of the injury. Flush with clean water for a minimum of 15 minutes and seek medical attention after flushing, not

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: Where is the nearest eye wash station on this job site? Has anyone ever had to use it?  
Q2: Is everyone wearing the correct eye protection for the tasks we are doing today?

#### KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Wear ANSI Z87.1-rated safety glasses minimum on all cutting operations
- Side shields are required when working near any projectile hazards
- Use goggles for chemical work or any overhead drilling and cutting tasks
- Inspect lenses for scratches — compromised lenses reduce protection
- Know the exact location of eye wash stations on your jobsite

*Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.*



# CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 27

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

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